Rebooking and Refund Policy for Homes

Airbnb Help Center, fully detailed summary - policy effective February 6, 2025

1. Purpose

This policy protects guests when something goes wrong with a home reservation that is the host's responsibility. When it applies, it takes precedence over the reservation's cancellation policy. It covers homes only, not experiences or services.

2. If the host cancels before check-in

- The guest is entitled to a full refund.
- Where appropriate, Airbnb helps the guest find a similar place, depending on availability at comparable pricing.
- Airbnb usually turns the original payment into travel credit so the guest can rebook immediately. The guest can instead ask for a refund to the original payment method.
- Travel credit left unused after 72 hours is refunded to the original payment method.

3. Reservation Issues that are covered

Issue	Examples
Host cancels	Host cancels the reservation before check-in.
No access	Host fails to provide access to the accommodation.
Not habitable	Not reasonably clean and sanitary, or contains safety or health hazards.
Different from listing	Wrong space type (entire place, private room, shared room); wrong type or number of bedrooms, bathrooms or kitchens; wrong location; undisclosed presence of the host, another person or a pet.
Missing amenity	An advertised special feature that is absent or not working, such as a pool, hot tub, major appliance, heating or air conditioning.

The lists are examples, not exhaustive.

4. How to request rebooking help or a refund

1. Report the issue within **72 hours** of discovering it (contact Airbnb or the host).
2. Where feasible, tell the host first and try to resolve it directly. Guests can request refunds from hosts through the Resolution Center.
3. Provide evidence: photos, videos, or confirmation of the conditions from the host.
4. Airbnb reviews the evidence and usually checks the report with the host. Hosts can dispute a report.

If reporting within 72 hours was not feasible, Airbnb may allow late reporting. Only the guest who made the reservation can submit the request.

5. How the outcome is decided

Airbnb can give a full refund, a partial refund, or rebooking help. The amount depends on the severity of the issue, its impact on the guest, the portion of the stay affected, whether the guest left the accommodation, other mitigating factors, and the strength of the evidence. Airbnb may reduce the amount by any refund the host already gave. When helping to rebook, Airbnb may, but does not have to, pay or contribute to the cost of new accommodation. Airbnb may

also offer the value of the cancelled reservation as travel credit instead of cash.

6. What is not covered

- Issues caused by the guest, co-travelers, invitees or pets.
- Fraudulent requests, which break the Terms of Service and can lead to account termination.
- Large-scale events such as disasters or travel bans, which fall under the Major Disruptive Events Policy.

7. Effect on hosts

If the host cancels or a Reservation Issue disrupts the stay, the host gets no payout or has the payout reduced by the amount refunded to the guest.

8. Other terms

- Airbnb's decisions under this policy are binding but do not remove other contractual or statutory rights, or the right to take legal action.
- It is not insurance, and rights under it cannot be transferred or assigned.
- Refund timing: Airbnb issues refunds almost immediately; arrival depends on the payment method (see When You'll Get Your Refund).

9. Common questions

Q: My host cancelled. What do I get?

A: A full refund, help finding a similar place, and usually travel credit that you can swap for a refund to your original payment method.

Q: The place was dirty or not as advertised. What do I do?

A: Contact the host and Airbnb within 72 hours with photos or videos. Airbnb decides on a full or partial refund or rebooking help.

Q: Is this policy the same as AirCover?

A: AirCover for guests is Airbnb's broader protection programme. This policy is the formal terms for rebooking and refunds on homes.

Q: Can I claim a refund for experiences or services?

A: No. This policy applies to homes only.

Sources

- Rebooking and refund policy for homes: airbnb.com/help/article/2868
- When you'll get your refund: airbnb.com/help/article/1967

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